PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Gel Extensions

Follow your state board rules and each brand's instructions and lamp pairing. Times vary by system.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. No fungus, infection, broken skin or lifting. Defer and refer if found.

ALLERGY CHECK

Ask about itching or rash after past gel. Any reaction: no acrylates; refer to a dermatologist.

PRE-CARE SENT

Arrive with bare nails or book removal time. No hand cream or oil on the day.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Hands washed, gloves on ☐ Implements disinfected ☐ New files and buffers ☐ Lamp matched to gel, timer set ☐ Tips sized, forms ready ☐ Ventilation on, SDS in reach

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & consent**	5 min	Review health changes, check consent is signed, photograph bare nails.
2	**Prep natural nail**	10 min	Push back cuticle; trim loose dead tissue only. Buff off shine, 180+ grit.
3	**Size tips**	5 min	Soft gel tips: fit each sidewall to sidewall. Etch the tip underside.
4	**Dehydrate & prime**	2 min	Dehydrator, then primer per brand. Don't touch the nail plate after.
5	**Bond or sculpt**	20–40 min	Tips: gel adhesive, flash cure, then full cure. Forms: fit snug, build length.
6	**Cure fully**	Per layer	Lamp matched to the gel, full stated time. Clean any gel off skin first.
7	**Shape**	10–15 min	File to the agreed length and shape. Check sidewalls are straight.
8	**Builder for strength**	10–20 min	Thin builder layer with the apex at the stress area. Cure.
9	**Color & top coat**	10–20 min	Gel color if booked, cap the free edge, top coat. Cure; wipe if required.
10	**Finish & check**	5 min	Cuticle oil. Check for sharp edges, lifting or gel on skin. After photos.
11	**Aftercare & rebook**	5 min	Review sheet and card. Book a fill at [3–4] weeks before they leave.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Smooth, even apex; no gel on skin or cuticles
- Removal: soft gel soaks off; hard gel is filed off
- Length suits the nail bed and [length policy]
- Uncured wipes go in a sealed metal bin

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Heat spike in the lamp: hand out, wait, resume. Use thinner layers.
- Glue or product in the eye: flush at the eyewash 15 minutes; seek care.
- Cut or nick: stop, clean, cover. No product on broken skin.
- Gel or adhesive on skin: remove before curing. Note it on the record.
- Itching, redness or blisters: remove product. No acrylates until a dermatologist assesses.
- Green spot or red, sore fold at a fill: remove, no new product, refer.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

System · brand	Tip sizes (R · L)	Builder · color · top	Lamp · cure time
Length · shape	**Skin · nail notes**	**Reaction or none**	**Next fill · initials**